How to Do a Handstand

These instructions explain how to perform a handstand. Performing a handstand involves safety risks and can lead to bodily harm if performed improperly.

Part 1: Obtaining the Handstand Position

Step 1: Stand with your heels against the base of the wall

Step 2: Take 3 steps (of your average step size) away from the wall

Step 3: Turn around in place

Step 4: Raise your arms up in the air so that they are parallel to your ears

Step 5: Lunge forward with your dominant foot *(Figure 1)*

Figure 1: Correct body leaning position for step 5. (Zivcic-Markovic, Kamenka, et al. "A Suggested Model of Handstand Teaching Method." *Fizicka Kultura*, vol. 69, no. 2, 2015, pp. 138–49. *DOI.org (Crossref)*, https://doi.org/10.5937/fizkul1502138Z)

Step 6: Focus your eyes on the floor just in front of the wall where your hands will go

Step 7: Tuck your chin towards your chest

Step 8: Kick your non-dominant leg backwards so that it and your arms (still parallel to your ears) lie in a horizontal plane above the ground, forming a "T" shape *(Figure 2)*

Figure 2: Ideal "T" shape discussed in step 8. (Zivcic-Markovic, Kamenka, et al. "A Suggested Model of Handstand Teaching Method." *Fizicka Kultura*, vol. 69, no. 2, 2015, pp. 138–49. *DOI.org (Crossref)*, https://doi.org/10.5937/fizkul1502138Z)

Step 9: Place your palms flat on the ground with your fingers spread apart

Step 10: Shift weight onto your hands and simultaneously push off the floor with your dominant foot

Step 11: Bring your legs together with your heels touching the wall *(Figure 3)*

Figure 3: Final handstand positioning. (Zivcic-Markovic, Kamenka, et al. "A Suggested Model of Handstand Teaching Method." *Fizicka Kultura*, vol. 69, no. 2, 2015, pp. 138–49. *DOI.org (Crossref)*, https://doi.org/10.5937/fizkul1502138Z)

Step 12: You have now achieved a handstand position.

Part 2: Dismounting from Handstand Position

Step 13: Drop your dominant leg back towards the floor

Step 14: Push off the ground with both hands and place your dominant foot on the floor

Step 15: Orient your body into the same “T” shape as before

Step 16: Raise your torso to a vertical position

Step 17: Place your feet together